

Image 1: Sintel treating Scales (the baby dragon)

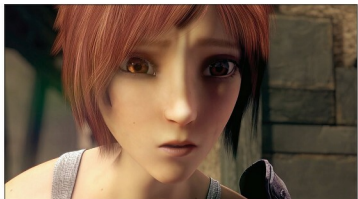


Image 2: Sintel's expression on meeting Scales

unprecedented detailing, storyline and the intense graphics work. Not to forget that the movie will be released in 4k renders as well! The work on the facial expressions is one of the parts that I liked the most. The graphics and detailing is mind-boggling, and is no less than what the top guns in the 3D industry could have delivered. It's quite amazing how Blender delivers such life-like motion and imagery without the backing of giants like Intel or AMD for rendering and processing. Surely, the Blender Foundation deserves a great round of applause for such astounding work.

The movie is quite good, and the story is much better compared to Blender's previous project, topped with brilliant voice-overs by Halina Rejin and Tom Hoffman for Sintel and Shaman, respectively. The music in the movie has been produced by Jan Morgenstern, and gels very well with the different moods of the movie, ranging from dark and brooding to soothing and upbeat.

Sintel comes in a 4-DVD set; being a pre-campaign sponsor, I got my DVD delivered right after the project ended. Getting this DVD not only provides you with a physical copy, but also helps fund future projects. The 4-DVD set has lots of goodies, including the model, texture, animation and rendering files used to make the film, as well as various quality renders, and PAL and NTSC versions of the finished film.

Sintel is licensed under Creative Commons Attribution 3.0 CC-BY, which states that if you own a hard or soft copy of the product, you own the work. Being an open source movie, you can study, edit, redesign the movie, and share it. The aim of the project is not only to produce films, but to fund the



Image 3: Sintel and the Shaman

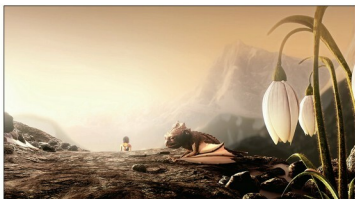


Image 4: The End

Blender Foundation's future projects, and establish Blender as a prominent 3D modelling software, since one of the strengths of Blender is creating life-like creatures.

Sintel lives up to expectations, and further validates Blender as a professional animation creation suite. It's a great movie with enough blood and emotion flowing through it right from the very beginning. A must-watch movie, it will be a great addition to your media gallery. However, the story-line might not be for everyone, and if you liked Big Buck Bunny, you might not like the sentimental aspect of this movie.

What's next? In an interview with Blenderguru.com, Ton spoke of the next open movie project: Mango. Not many details are out yet, but we did get a glimpse of what could possibly be on the way. 

Ratings

- Direction: 4 / 5
- Screenplay: 4 / 5
- Story Line: 3.5 / 5
- Animation and 3D Model: 4.25 / 5
- Sound: 4.5 / 5
- Overall: 4 / 5

By: Shashwat Pant

The author is a FOSS/hardware enthusiast who likes to review software and tweak his hardware for optimum performance. He is interested in Python/Qt programming, and fond of benchmarking the latest FOSS distros and software.